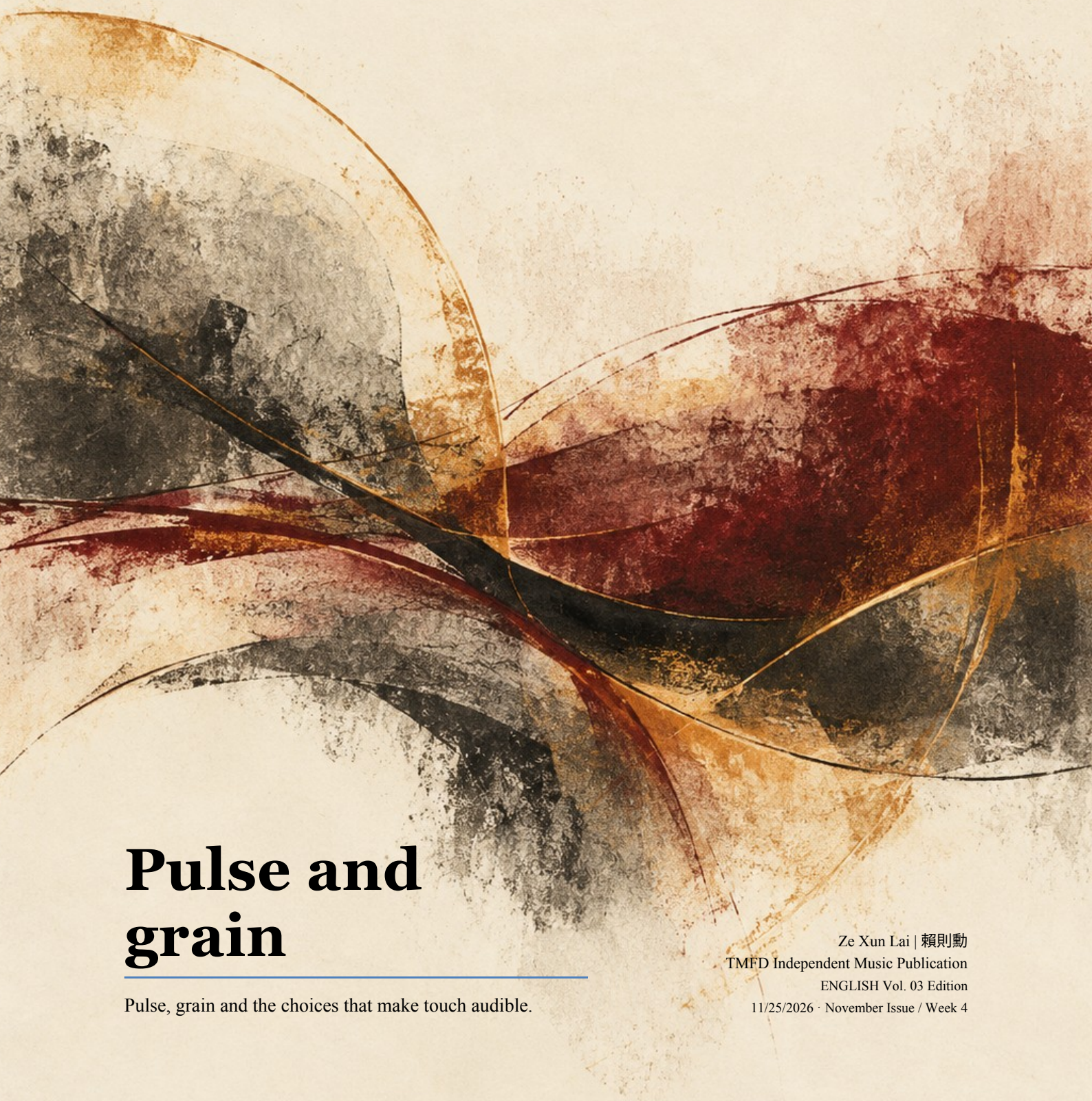
# TMFD



# Pulse and grain

Pulse, grain and the choices that make touch audible.

Ze Xun Lai | 賴則勳

TMFD Independent Music Publication
ENGLISH Vol. 03 Edition
11/25/2026 · November Issue / Week 4



Pulse, grain and the choices that make touch audible.

Select any chapter title or page number to jump directly.


## 01 Editor’s Letter

A weekly needs more than one centre · 2

## 02 Back Catalogue

Eight records where touch keeps form in view · 3

## 03 Featured Essay

Tigran Hamasyan: pulse, attack and return · 7

## 04 New Music

Six current releases, six different materials · 10

## 05 Live Performance

A filmed body changes the room · 13

## 06 Instruments & Material Culture

Yamaha CP88 and CP73 in actual use · 14

## 07 Calendar & Outlook

Taipei dates and their practical conditions · 17

## 08 Credits & Sources

Images, listening and primary references · 18

# Pulse and grain

A weekly becomes credible when its subjects do not all answer the same question. This issue follows pulse and grain across eight long-view records, current releases, a three-page Tigran Hamasyan reading, a filmed performance, stage-piano decisions and Taipei announcements. The feature is a centre of pressure, not a monopoly on attention.

> A phrase becomes legible when its returns give a listener somewhere to stand.

The back catalogue moves from Zs’s changing ensemble attack through Mabe Fratti’s side-stepping materials and Loraine James’s electronic detail, then toward Jlin, Nala Sinephro, Rian Treanor and Moor Mother. The new-music section begins with named credits, source materials and production roles before offering a listening judgment.

A strong issue must make its methods visible without becoming a worksheet. The Hamasyan feature separates public credits, audible claims and limits; the gear section separates stated specifications from a player’s practical decision; the calendar separates an official notice from a recommendation. Density comes from these distinctions, not from piling up adjectives.

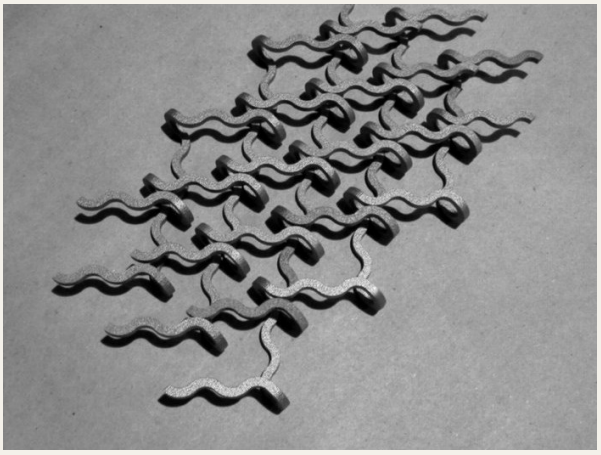
## Method before verdict

No score, tempo map or numerical chart substitutes for listening. Public pages document releases, products or events; criticism names an audible event and leaves room for another listener to disagree. The reader can follow every image and assertion to a stated source, then return to the recording with a different conclusion.

# Zs

## Xe

2015



Zs, Xe. Official release cover.

Zs · official release page

Xe treats ensemble attack as a sequence of changing surfaces rather than a stable accompaniment. The useful question is not whether an entry is loud, but whether it arrives as a cut, a held edge or an altered continuation of what came before. Follow one short figure across a return: when its grain changes, the listener’s sense of where a phrase begins can change with it.

Official listening · Bandcamp

Artist and release reference

# Mabe Fratti

## Sentir que no sabes

2024




Mabe Fratti, Sentir que no sabes. Official release cover.

Mabe Fratti · official release page

Fratti’s writing makes uncertainty productive without making every sound equally important. A vocal colour, bowed line or abrupt collective entry can turn the apparent centre of a phrase sideways. Listen for what remains after a gesture has passed: the most durable material is often not the peak but the texture that forces the next instrument to enter at a different scale.

Official listening · Bandcamp

Artist and release reference

# Mary Halvorson

## Amaryllis

2022



Mary Halvorson, Amaryllis. Official release cover.

Mary Halvorson · official release page

Amaryllis uses its ensemble as a sequence of changing responsibilities: a guitar colour can turn from interruption into connective tissue, while brass and rhythm section keep the composition from being reduced to one soloist’s profile. Rather than treating the guitar as the automatic foreground, follow when it leaves a gap for a horn response or when a sustained colour changes how the ensemble’s next chord reads.

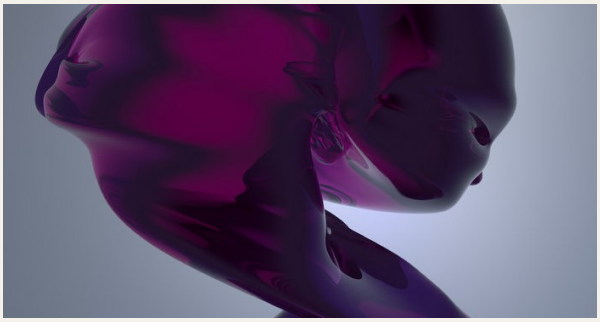
Official listening · Bandcamp

Artist and release reference

# Loraine James

## Reflection

2021



Loraine James, Reflection. Official release cover.

Loraine James · official release page

Reflection does not ask its electronic detail to behave as a backdrop. A programmed surface can interrupt a vocal trace, or a lyric-led line can make a fractured rhythm sound suddenly intimate. Rather than flattening those shifts into “contrast”, listen for which layer is allowed to keep the aftermath of an attack and which layer must begin the next phrase from zero.

Official listening · Bandcamp

Artist and release reference

# Jlin

## Black Origami

2017



Jlin, Black Origami. Official release cover.

Jlin · official release page

The official release identifies twelve Jerrilynn Patton compositions and credits collaborators on selected tracks. Its percussion-led writing matters because repetition does not settle into accompaniment: each return changes the contour against which the next attack is heard.

Official listening · Bandcamp

Artist and release reference

# Nala Sinephro

## Space 1.8

2021




Nala Sinephro, Space 1.8. Official release cover.

Nala Sinephro · official release page

The release credits modular synth, harp, saxophone, piano, guitar, drums and double bass across different pieces. That changing personnel turns “ambient” from a genre shortcut into a question of which colour enters, sustains and leaves space for another.

Official listening · Bandcamp

Artist and release reference

# Rian Treanor

## File Under UK Metaplasm

2020



Rian Treanor, File Under UK Metaplasm. Official release cover.

Rian Treanor · official release page

The official notes place this second Planet Mu album between club function and heavily altered rhythm. Its pressure comes from preserving forward motion while the surface repeatedly threatens to splinter; form is heard as recovery, not smoothness.

Official listening · Bandcamp

Artist and release reference

# Moor Mother

## Jazz Codes (Deluxe Edition)

2023



Moor Mother, Jazz Codes (Deluxe Edition). Official release cover.

Moor Mother · official release page

The expanded release assembles short pieces with distinct guests rather than treating the album as a neutral archive. Changes of voice, instrumentation and duration become the argument: density can mean accumulation, but it can also mean rapid editorial framing.

Official listening · Bandcamp

Artist and release reference

# Pulse becomes a form of touch

## One recording, several roles

The Call Within credits piano, keyboards, voice, synthesisers, effects, electronic drums, bass and drums. That is a verifiable resource list, not proof of what any bar means. The useful question is narrower: which attack establishes return, which register changes perceived weight, and which layer makes the next arrival legible without simply doubling it? Separate duration from prominence: a bright attack can draw attention without marking the larger cycle, while a quiet low register can make a new entrance feel necessary.

## Begin with what can be heard

Start with a recurring piano onset and note the moment it reappears. On the next pass, ask whether the drum response confirms it, delays it or throws another contour across it. Then notice whether the lowest sustained sound functions as bass line, resonance field or temporary floor. This is a listening protocol, not transcription; without a published score, detailed labels remain provisional. Replay the same span from one audible attack earlier. If the proposed pulse disappears, that earlier event was doing more work than expected.

## The recording can remain larger than the player

Official visual work places composition beside image, voice and performance space. It does not establish technical facts about every recording, but it does show why physical gesture changes the reception of an attack: a hand may read as a source of line, percussion or interruption depending on what the mix allows it to carry. The useful comparison is sequential. Listen once with the image absent; note the onset whose return establishes orientation; then watch and ask whether the camera makes that event clearer, substitutes visible effort for it, or draws attention to another layer. The video supplies a second route through the work, not a license to infer exact meter, tempo or bar structure from a hand movement.

## What the image cannot settle

An official moving image can establish that a visual presentation exists; it cannot identify every audible layer or prove a count. The disciplined use of it is comparative. Describe one audible return first, then state what the camera makes easier to notice: a hand’s arrival, a change of register, a cue, or the distance between players. If image and sound disagree about emphasis, do not force agreement. That difference is the observation. A camera can make a preparatory movement conspicuous even when the decisive onset is elsewhere in the mix; it can also hide a sustaining role whose effect is obvious in audio. Keep a two-part note: what is heard before looking, then what becomes visible after looking. The second note may refine attention, but it cannot revise the first into a technical claim the recording does not support. This is why an official video is evidence of presentation and gesture, not a substitute for a score, a tempo map or a multi-track session.

## Pulse is not the grouping

A pulse is the repeatable reference a listener can tap; grouping is the ordered shape of attacks inside it. A phrase may retain four large spans while marking 3+3+2 across them. Calling everything “odd meter” confuses rate, grouping and return. The real question is which recurrence keeps direction audible.

## A small repeatability test

Choose one stable attack unit u for a listening pass. If one layer returns every 8u and another every 5u, the next common restart occurs at LCM(8,5)=40u. This is a model, not a transcription claim about a named recording. It makes a precise question repeatable: where does shared orientation return?

## Attack reveals function

Describe an event before naming a meter: onset time, register, attack profile and perceived decay can be noted without claiming a studio measurement. A low onset may hold pulse while a high short attack changes the phrase edge. Tap pulse, mark attacks, then compare the next common return.



Tigran Hamasyan, official image for “New Maps”. Tigran Hamasyan · official video page

# Gibrana Cervantes

## Verdad y Error

16 OCTOBER 2026




Gibrana Cervantes, Verdad y Error. Official release cover.

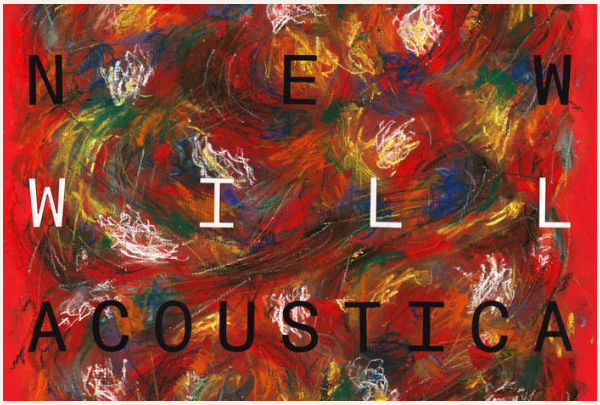
Gibrana Cervantes · official release page

Each timbral decision asks whether a sound should be edge, atmosphere or interruption. That is a compositional question before it is a genre question. A close listening task is to locate the instant at which an abrasive colour ceases to be decoration and begins to divide a phrase. The answer will depend on level and playback space, so it should be framed as a hearing report rather than a claim about a fixed mix hierarchy.

# Alarm Will Sound

## New Acoustica

23 OCTOBER 2026




Alarm Will Sound, New Acoustica. Official release cover.

Alarm Will Sound · official release page

Colour is not a finishing touch. Redistribution of articulation, weight and register can make a transition feel large without simple loudness. The useful detail is not whether an arrangement sounds “orchestral”, but where an attack changes responsibility: a colour that first reads as surface may later become the event that gives a subsequent entrance its scale. Listen for those transfers rather than treating timbre as a finishing layer.

Official release · Bandcamp

Release reference

# Kristin Sofroniou

## Darkness Visible

20 NOVEMBER 2026



Kristin Sofroniou, Darkness Visible. Official release cover.

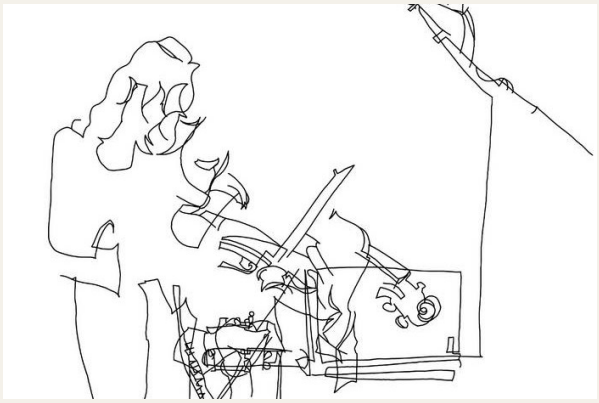
Kristin Sofroniou · official release page

The pre-release page names piano, keyboards, programming, field recordings and transformed Bach material. Those are public credits, not a substitute for a hearing. They do, however, establish a useful listening question: where does a remembered keyboard contour survive electronic treatment, and where does its source become less important than the pressure of the transition it creates?

# more eaze

## Valley and Structure

09 OCTOBER 2026



more eaze, Valley and Structure. Official release cover.

more eaze · official release page

Arrangement becomes terrain rather than hierarchy. Quiet movement deserves as much attention as an obvious climax. Follow which layer remains after the expected high point has passed: if a small electronic trace keeps re-colouring a quiet field, it may be the work’s durable structural voice rather than a detail waiting to be replaced by a louder gesture.

Official release · Bandcamp

Release reference

# Timothy Fairless

## Friction

02 OCTOBER 2026



Timothy Fairless, Friction. Official release cover.

Timothy Fairless · official release page

The official notes identify field recordings, synthesisers, lap steel, percussion, viola and voice across four extended pieces. The critical task is to hear whether processing merely smooths those sources or lets their locations keep exerting pressure on form. In a practical comparison, listen once for instrumental contour and once for the edge of a recorded place; if those impressions cannot be separated cleanly, that friction is an artistic result, not a failure of classification.

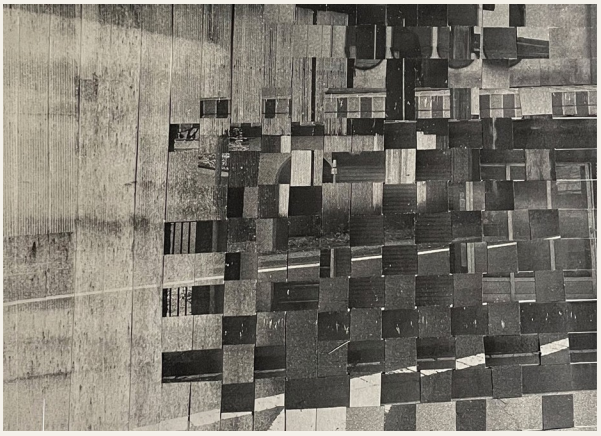
Official release · Bandcamp

Release reference

# A_A

## Ubiquity

01 OCTOBER 2026



A_A, Ubiquity. Official release cover.

A_A · official release page

The release credits collected samples and live instruments, with production by A_A, mixing by Satoshi Tomiie and mastering by Mike Grinser. Its stated 24-bit vinyl-cutting master is a production fact; it does not itself settle how the record moves in a room. Production credits identify responsibility, while listening asks a different question: when do layered materials behave as a single mass, and when does one return make their seams audible again?

Official release · Bandcamp

Release reference

# A filmed body changes the room

## Tigran Hamasyan

Official video selection

CURRENT OFFICIAL PROGRAMME
Official video · Tigran Hamasyan



Tigran Hamasyan, official live-performance image.

Tigran Hamasyan · official video page

Film cannot certify a count or replace a recording. It can, however, redistribute evidence: camera distance decides whether touch reads as choreography, effort or a means of cueing another musician; cuts can conceal a return that audio makes unusually clear. Read the image after the sound, not in place of it.

## Recorded return

Filmed attention

A recording distributes responsibility between layers; a film selects where the viewer is invited to look. That gap matters most when dense rhythm invites the eye to mistake visible effort for the source of every audible event.

Official video · Tigran Hamasyan

## Before pressing play

Start with the recording, then watch the official video. Note one repeated event that stays audible without looking, then identify the visual decision that either clarifies or distracts from it. The comparison is a way to test attention, not to rank media.

Official video page

# Instruments preserve a decision

## Two stage pianos, two physical limits

Key count, action, carrying weight, control layout and local service conditions change the rehearsal and performance a player can plan. The manufacturer’s figures establish a decision boundary; they do not say whether a particular part needs an 88-key compass, whether a player prefers the action, or whether a local route can support a repair. Specifications and editorial judgement therefore stay separate here.



Yamaha CP88, complete instrument view. Official product image.

Yamaha · official product page

## Yamaha CP88

Yamaha Japan listed CP88 at JPY 319,000 when checked on 26 October 2026, alongside an 88-key layout and stated 18.6 kg mass. Those facts favour a full-range, more fixed-stage proposition: a player can retain low-register and upper-register writing without changing keyboard. The practical cost is not only price but carrying, flight-case choice, stage access and whether the action can be tried before purchase.

Yamaha Japan · JPY 319,000 · checked 26 OCT 2026



CP series controls and keys. Official feature image.

Yamaha Music Connect · official feature

# Price does not settle fit

## Use, route and trial

A useful trial has a defined job. Play the actual lowest and highest notes required in a current set; alternate repeated accents with sustained harmony; switch quickly between piano and layered sound; then move the instrument as it would be moved to rehearsal. A retailer page can identify a route, but it cannot settle touch, monitoring response or fatigue.

Buying conditions




CP Series on stage stand. Official gallery image.

Yamaha · official gallery

## Yamaha CP73

Yamaha Japan listed CP73 at JPY 264,000 when checked on 26 October 2026, with 73 keys and stated 13.1 kg mass. The smaller instrument changes more than luggage: it asks whether the repertoire needs the omitted extremes, whether splits can replace them, and whether frequent loading is a larger constraint than full compass. Reduced range is a plan, not an automatic compromise.

Yamaha Japan · JPY 264,000 · checked 26 OCT 2026




CP series transport case. Official accessory image.

Yamaha Music Connect · official feature

## The purchase has a border

Japanese maker prices are not Taiwan landed cost. Before treating either figure as a recommendation, confirm local stock, authorised retailer terms, freight, tax, warranty territory, repair access, return conditions and a physical trial. A specification sheet can specify the product; it cannot guarantee local support or make an untested action fit a player.

Yamaha · official product page · conditions vary by territory



CP series in playing position. Official feature image.

Yamaha Music Connect · official feature

## A useful instrument is a bounded promise

Neither model makes a technique more truthful. Their differences give a player concrete tests: required range, number of carry events, action over a full rehearsal, control changes under low light, and the nearest credible repair route. A purchase is sound when those tests have answers.

# Dates near the room

## BABYMONSTER

21–22 NOVEMBER 2026 · TAIPEI

YG’s official notice lists Taipei dates on 21 and 22 November. It establishes date and city, not door time, ticket status or venue rules. Recheck the linked official route immediately before travel; a later promoter notice controls.

Official event information

## UVERworld

21 NOVEMBER 2026 · ZEPP NEW TAIPEI

UVERworld’s official Chinese-language notice lists Zepp New Taipei. Recheck the official notice and current venue information for door time, ticket access, change or cancellation before travel.

Official event information

## A calendar is a live document

CHECK LOCAL UPDATES

Official listings can change after publication. Near the date, prefer the newest official notice when public pages disagree.

Official routes only

## Dates make conditions visible

Dates make a room, ticket route and changing access visible. That demands precise reporting, not publicity copy.

## A listing is not a verdict

Official notices are evidence of a proposed encounter, not a substitute for listening. No StreetVoice material is used.

# Images and sources

## Images

Official artist, release and manufacturer images; TMFD issue art

Source / editorial basis

Tigran Hamasyan · official artist and video images

Source / editorial basis

Yamaha · official product images

Source / editorial basis

TMFD · issue-specific abstract cover and contents art

Source / editorial basis

Bandcamp artist release covers · official artist pages

Source / editorial basis

Interior images are named to their subjects

Source / editorial basis

Tigran Hamasyan · official video image

Source / editorial basis

Yamaha CP88 · official manufacturer image

Source / editorial basis

Yamaha CP73 / CP Series · official manufacturer images

Source / editorial basis

All image routes and roles are retained in the source ledger

Source / editorial basis

No generic filler graphics are used.

Source / editorial basis

No chart claims appear without reproducible source material.

Source / editorial basis

Sources checked 26 October 2026.

Source / editorial basis

## Primary references

Tigran Hamasyan · official The Call Within and video pages

Gibrana Cervantes, Alarm Will Sound, Kristin Sofroniou and more eaze · official release pages

Timothy Fairless and A_A · official release pages

Yamaha CP88 / CP73 · official product and published-price pages

YG Entertainment and UVERworld · official Taiwan notices

Zs, Mabe Fratti, Mary Halvorson, Loraine James, Jlin, Nala Sinephro, Rian Treanor and Moor Mother · official release pages

The source ledger distinguishes fact, editorial reading and limitation.

Source check: 26 October 2026; listings, prices and availability may change.

Japanese maker prices do not state a Taiwan landed cost.

Listening, event and evidence links are identified separately.

This issue uses no StreetVoice material.